Graphic Design

Layout in InDesign

Summary Notes

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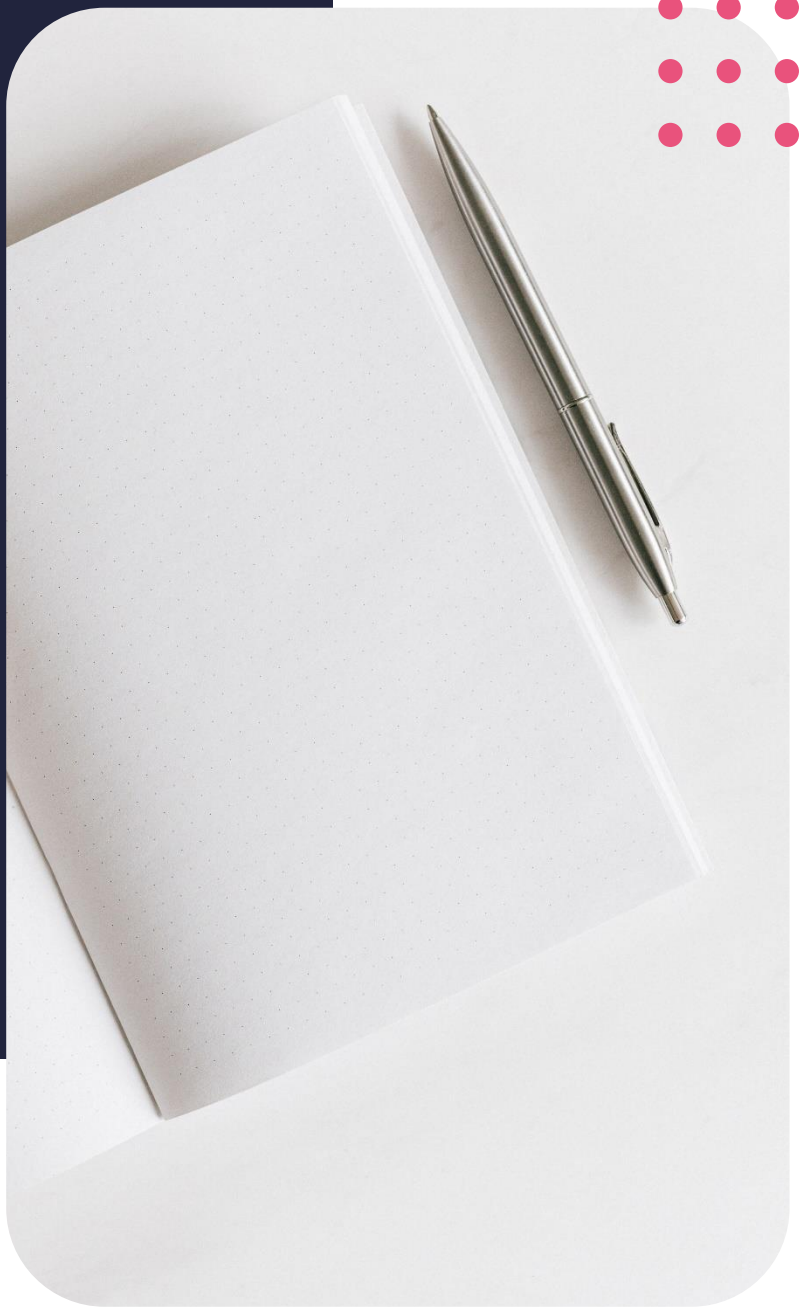


Lesson outcomes

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Lesson outcome 1: Basic photography
- Lesson outcome 2: Using a grid

Introduction

At the end of this course, we will take all the work that you have done and create an amazing portfolio that you can use to showcase your extraordinary ability.

Basic Photography

Punctuation is used for clarifying a written sentence to avoid misinterpretation. This include punctuation marks like the , . ? Colon, but also capital letters, paragraphing and indicating the end or beginning of a sentence.

But did you know that during the middle-ages, with the evolution of the written language still in progress, punctuation was almost non-existent?

There was no identification of the beginning or end of a sentence and writings were done in either square capitals or rustic capitals. Lowercase letters only evolved later from design traits from Carolingian miniscule.

Punctuation was indicated by the variable sizes between words.

Considering how grammar and punctuation has evolved, it is a lot easier to read and understand and makes you appreciate these small details a lot more. If not for punctuation, we would all misinterpret one another.

Let's end off module two from an inspiring quote by design influencer, Paula Scher again. "The thing that's most to be feared, is doing the same thing over and over again."

In any creative field, you will need to constantly adapt and change your methods for doing things. Doing the same things over will not help you in growing and your creativity will suffer due to this. As difficult as change may seem sometimes, embrace it because the more you change things, the easier this process becomes.

Using a grid

This lesson entails designing a magazine cover from the content we have created specifically from previous lessons so far. Before you simply jump in and create your magazine, because getting over excited can cost you unnecessary time and effort.

Like with all designs, consider your 5 steps in the design cycle before blatantly jumping into the deep end.

Have you been applying these steps to your designs that you have been creating? These steps include, briefing, research & brainstorming, thumbnails, production and present.

I would like to focus on the thumbnails stage specifically. When it comes to layout design in general but specifically publication design, we make use of a grid to organise our elements.

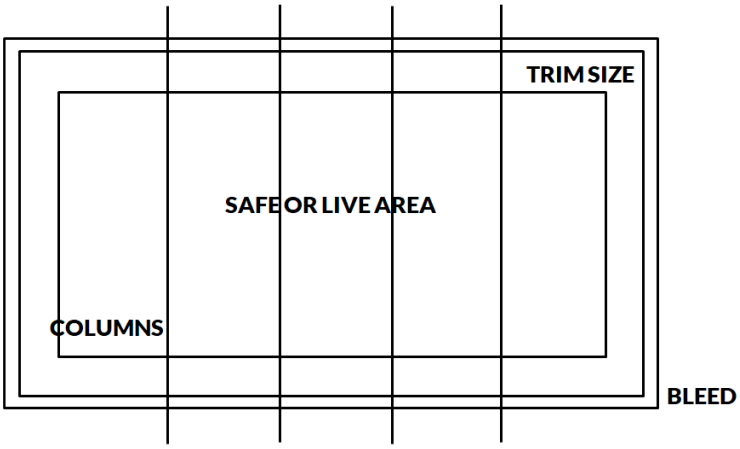
The whole idea of a grid is to make the design process easier and quicker, so don't let the process put you off. So, when designing your thumbnails, consider your grid and how all your elements will be laid out on your grid. The idea is to use your grid creatively but still make the content understandable. We don't live in the middle ages any longer, so practicality and functionality are key.

The first step is to determine the size and ratio of your document size, whether it is for digital or printing purposes. This is referred to as the trim size.

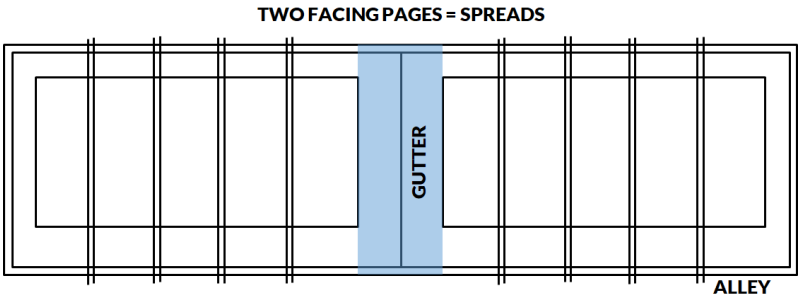
Next, add your bleed, which, as you should know by now is around 3mm or 0,125" for printed documents.

Next determine your safe or live area and this is the area we use to make sure that the content within this area is printed or visible on screen – remember when I constantly say "have generous margins"? Well, this refers to your safe or live area.

Other terms we will look into today are columns, gutter and alley. As you know by now columns are the vertical lines indicating legs of paragraphs.



Gutters are found when you have two facing pages. These two facing pages are known as spreads. The gutter is the generous margins between two facing pages, especially when it comes to binding documents like magazines and books. Make sure that your safe area is far from the inside of your pages and that your gutter has generous margins.



Please refer to the recording for the InDesign demo:

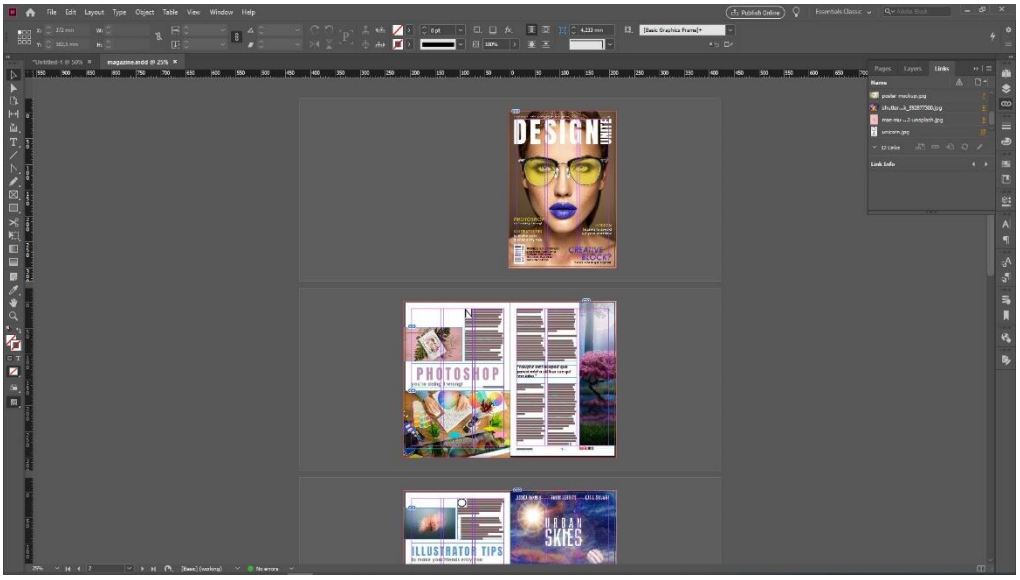
Master pages

Create a grid: layout > create guides (in master pages)

Add page numbering in Master pages

Character styles

Dummy text (placeholder text)



Conclusion

I am sure that after this demo, you have fallen in love with InDesign, just like I love this amazing application. If you also wonder how I create these realistic examples of my artwork, join me for our later modules and I will show the ways of the masters.

In case you forgot, we learnt some cool tricks in InDesign today, and if this did not blow your mind, wait until we start creating interactive PDF's with InDesign!

We learnt how to make use of the master page function and added page numbers and creating character styles. If this does not stir your passion to become a better designer, I would suggest you familiarise yourself even more with these programs. Because the more familiar you get using them, the more skills you will pick up.

Coming up, we will investigate other aspects of the graphic design field including creative thinking to help you stimulate your concepts and ideas. We will create interactive documents to make your friends envy you, packaging design is one of our topics and more amazing photo editing techniques.